

SENATE RESOLUTION 432

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor Dr. Ollie Liddell on being named the
2026 Outstanding High School Music Educator.

WHEREAS, the members of this legislative body take great pleasure in paying tribute to an outstanding educator who helps his students discover deeper meaning in life and develop important skills through music instruction; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Ollie Liddell, Director of Bands at Memphis Central High School, has been named the 2026 Outstanding High School Music Educator by the Tennessee Music Education Association (TMEA) in recognition of his "dedication to excellence, student achievement, and the lasting impact of music education"; and

WHEREAS, since joining Memphis Central High School in 2012, Dr. Liddell has developed a nationally respected band program that is built on high expectations, strong relationships, and a commitment to continuous growth; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, students have earned numerous superior ratings and national recognitions, reflecting both the strength of the program and the dedication of the young musicians he serves; and

WHEREAS, on the same day that Dr. Liddell was honored with the TMEA Outstanding High School Music Educator award, several Memphis Central students were participating in All-State performances, continuing the school's strong tradition of musical excellence; and

WHEREAS, under Dr. Liddell's expert direction, Memphis Central participated in the prestigious Essentially Ellington Jazz Competition, a defining moment for his students and their confidence in themselves; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Liddell's great influence is demonstrated by his former students' career choices; many of them have become music educators, while others continue to perform professionally or maintain music as a lifelong passion; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Liddell encourages his students to strive for excellence without limitations, urging them to measure their growth against the highest standards and pushing them to continually refine their skills; and

WHEREAS, by maintaining rigorous expectations while celebrating progress, Dr. Liddell helps students develop resilience, discipline, and confidence that support success in all areas of life; and

WHEREAS, music has long been a central part of Dr. Liddell's life; his father was a band director and former Director of Bands at Jackson State University, and he grew up immersed in the discipline and creativity that music fosters; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Liddell spent nearly a decade touring as a professional musician before returning to higher education to earn advanced degrees in music education, including a PhD; and

WHEREAS, if student growth is the true measure of a teacher's success, then Dr. Liddell has achieved an even greater milestone than this prestigious award, for he has inspired his young musicians to reach for great heights and bright futures; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Ollie Liddell is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and congratulate Dr. Ollie Liddell on being named the 2026 Outstanding High School Music Educator by the Tennessee Music Education Association, recognize his exemplary service as Director of Bands

at Memphis Central High School, and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.